

AFL-CIO LEGISLATIVE SCORECARD

2012

Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard
Retrieved	8 August 2026
Records	21 House, 11 Senate

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

1. Countervailing Duty Provisions to Non-market Economy Countries

	H.R. 4105 · March 6, 2012
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 370 NAYs 39
	The bill affirms the Commerce Department has the authority to impose countervailing duties on imports from non-market economy countries-including China-that engage in unfair trade practices. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/countervailing-duty-provisions-non-market-economy-countries

2. Jumpstart Our Business Startups

	H.R. 3606 · March 8, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 390 NAYs 23
	The "Jumpstart Our Business Startups (JOBS) Act" would reduce critical regulatory protections for investors that are essential to safeguarding the retirement savings of America's workers from fraud and other risks. The so-called "Jobs Act" would create few jobs and would instead inevitably weaken investor confidence in our capital markets by creating new and expanded loopholes in our securities laws. Weakened securities regulations increase the danger of fraud and speculation. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/jumpstart-our-business-startups

3. Amendment to Cut Funding to Social Security, Medicare and Medicaid

	H.Amdt. 1001 to H.Con.Res. 112 · March 28, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 38 NAYs 382
	This substitute to the Republican budget resolution offered by Rep. Jim Cooper (R-Tenn.) and Rep. Steve LaTourette (R-Ohio) would make makes deep cuts in Social Security benefits, cuts to Medicare benefits and Medicaid, offer more tax incentives for U.S. firms to export jobs overseas, tax working Americans' health benefits and lower tax rates for rich people and Wall Street. Instead of fixing the economy and solving this country's problems, the Cooper-LaTourette budget resolution would double down on the same mistakes that drove the economy into a ditch in 2008. Economic inequality is at its highest level seen since the 1920s, yet this budget resolution would lower the top marginal individual tax rate and the top corporate income tax rate. The amendment was rejected.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-cut-funding-social-security-medicare-and-medicaid

4. FY2013 Budget Resolution

	H.Con.Res. 112 · March 29, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 228 NAYs 191
	This Republican budget resolution, crafted by Rep. Paul Ryan (R-Wisc.), caps spending and makes major cuts in vital working family programs while cutting tax rates for the richest Americans and Wall Street. Its more egregious provisions include privatizing Medicare, gutting Medicaid and repealing the 2010 health care reform law-the Affordable Care Act (ACA). The Ryan/Republican budget would increase the number of Americans without health insurance by 30 million by repealing the ACA, and its cuts to Medicaid by making it a block grant program would add another 14 to 27 million to the rolls of uninsured rolls. The Ryan/Republican budget also makes it easier to make cuts in Social Security by removing current protections. It undermines U.S. economic growth over the long term by eliminating productive federal investments in infrastructure, education, worker training, manufacturing and clean energy. The resolution was adopted.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/fy2013-budget-resolution

5. Small Business Tax Cut Act

H.R. 9 · April 19, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 235 NAYs 173

Touted as part of the Republicans so-called "jobs" package, the bill doesn't include a single requirement that businesses create jobs or invest within the United States before qualifying for the new tax deductions. It simply adds even more tax loop holes for businesses to take advantage of. It allows businesses with fewer less than 500 employees to deduct 20% of their domestic business income. The Joint Committee on Taxation found that H.R. 9's impact on economic growth and jobs is "so small as to be incalculable." The Urban-Brookings Tax Policy Center estimates that nearly half of the \$46 billion tax cut would go to people with incomes more than \$1 million a year. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/small-business-tax-cut-act>

6. Small Business Credit Availability Act

H.R. 3336 · April 25, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 312 NAYs 111

This bill offered by Rep. Frank Lucas (R-Okla.) would exempt certain financial institutions that are major players in derivatives trading from provisions of the 2010 Wall Street reform law that would classify those institutions as a type of derivatives trader known as swap dealers. Derivatives trading was a major cause of the 2008 financial crash. The bill would expand loopholes and exemptions covering derivatives already in the Dodd-Frank Wall Street reform law, and would undermine comprehensive oversight of the derivatives market by financial regulatory agencies. H.R. 3336 would have unpredictable and possibly dangerous consequences. The bill passed under a provision known as suspension of the rules that requires a two-thirds majority vote.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/small-business-credit-availability-act>

7. Sequester Replacement Reconciliation Act of 2012

H.R. 5652 · May 10, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 218 NAYs 199

If Congress cannot agree on a budget deficit package by the end of year, automatic spending cuts known as budget sequestration will take place under provisions of last year's legislation that raised the debt ceiling. H.R. 5652 sponsored by Rep. Paul Ryan (R-Wisc.) replaces billions in spending cuts outlined in the 2011 legislation with cuts in programs that are helping millions of families survive the worst economic recession since the Great Depression. Forty percent of the total \$324 billion in cuts in mandatory spending comes from programs targeted to low- and moderate-income families, including food stamps, Medicaid, the Children's Health Insurance Program and social services for vulnerable children and elderly and disabled poor. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/sequester-replacement-reconciliation-act-2012>

8. Violence Against Women Reauthorization Act of 2012

H.R. 4970 · May 16, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 222 NAYs 205

The Republican bill to reauthorize the 1994 Violence Against Women Act weakens many current protections in the law. It excludes lesbian, gay, bisexual and transgender (LGBT) victims, erodes important provisions for immigrant victims' safety and gives abusers additional tools with which to harm victims. It fails to address the crisis of violence against American Indian women by not recognizing tribal court authority to hold perpetrators accountable and fails to include key provisions needed to help reduce violence against young victims of violence. The bill passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/violence-against-women-reauthorization-act-2012>

9. Amendment to Prohibit Project Labor Agreements

H.Amdt. 1106 to H.R. 4310 · May 17, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 211 NAYs 209

This amendment by Rep. Roscoe Bartlett (R-Md.) to the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2013 (H.R. 4310) prohibited the use of Project Labor Agreements (PLAs) on projects funded through the bill. PLAs are a proven, effective tool used to ensure the timely, cost-effective completion of large and complex projects, providing a better value for government agencies and the taxpayers who fund these projects. They also provide contractors—union and nonunion, alike—access to a properly trained and highly skilled workforce. The amendment was approved.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-prohibit-project-labor-agreements>

10. Amendment to Privatize Department of Defense Jobs

H.Amdt. 1112 to H.R. 4310 · May 18, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 209 NAYs 211
Rep. Mike Coffman (R-Colo.) offered an amendment to the Defense Authorization bill that would make it easier to privatize Defense Department work and services now conducted by civilian DOD employees, and make it more difficult to return contracted work and services to the DOD civilian workforce. The amendment was rejected.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-privatize-department-defense-jobs>

11. Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century Act

H.R. 4348 · May 18, 2012
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 245 NAYs 169
The House and Senate passed different versions of legislation temporarily extending funding for the Surface Transportation Act to keep millions of workers on transportation infrastructure projects employed. Rep. Nick Rahall, (D-W.Va.) offered a motion to instruct House conferees to agree to a Senate-passed Buy American requirements, which generally mandate that the materials for federally-funded highway, transit and rail projects be produced in the United States. The motion was approved.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/moving-ahead-progress-21st-century-act>

12. Amendment to Strike a Project Labor Agreement Prohibition Provision

H.Amdt. 1160 to H.R. 5854 · May 31, 2012
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 218 NAYs 198
A provision in the Military Construction and Veterans Affairs and Related Agencies Appropriations Act, 2013 (H.R. 5854) prohibited the use of Project Labor Agreements (PLAs) on projects funded through the bill. This amendment by Rep. Michael Grimm (R-N.Y.) removed the PLA ban from the bill. PLAs are a proven, effective tool used to ensure the timely, cost-effective completion of large and complex projects, providing a better value for government agencies and the taxpayers who fund these projects. They also provide contractors—union and nonunion, alike—access to a properly trained and highly skilled workforce. The amendment was approved.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-strike-project-labor-agreement-prohibition-provision>

13. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

H.R. 5854 · May 31, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 180 NAYs 237
This amendment by Rep. Trent Franks (R-Ariz.) to the Military Construction and Veterans Affairs Appropriations Act, 2013 (H.R. 5854) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws-0>

14. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

H.R. 5325 · June 6, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 184 NAYs 235
This amendment by Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) to the TK TK would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws>

15. Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century Act

H.R. 4348 · June 8, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 82 NAYs 323
The reauthorization of the Surface Transportation Act would create or maintain 2 million jobs, make vital investments in our decaying transportation infrastructure, and boost the overall economy. When the House and Senate versions were in conference, Rep. Paul Broun (R-Ga.), offered a motion to instruct conferees to drastically cut the funding, especially for mass transit, which would jeopardize hundreds of thousands of jobs. The motion failed.
Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/moving-ahead-progress-21st-century-act-0>

16. Repeal of Obamacare Act

H.R. 6079 · July 11, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 244 NAYs 185

Shortly after the U.S. Supreme Court ruled that the Affordable Care Act (ACA) was constitutional, congressional Republicans held their 33rd vote to repeal the health care reform law. The ACA improves access to affordable health care coverage, provides consumer protections, and reduces the federal deficit. If repealed, 1.2 million young adults would lose their coverage through their parents' health plan; 2.7 million seniors would pay higher prices for prescription drugs; 44 million seniors would be denied free preventive services; and insurance companies would be allowed to resume denying coverage, limiting care and spending premiums on larger CEO salaries and profits. The legislation passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/repeal-obamacare-act>

17. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

H.R. 5856 · July 18, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 182 NAYs 235

This amendment by Rep. Steve King (R-Iowa) to the Department of Defense Appropriations Act, 2013 (H.R. 5856) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws-1>

18. Red Tape Reduction and Small Business Job Creation Act

H.R. 4078 · July 26, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 245 NAYs 172

As part of their so-called "jobs plan," House Republicans offered a bill that would in effect ban any new federal regulations-from job safety to rules for big banks and public health- until the unemployment rate drops to 6 percent or less. The bill would put workers and the public in danger, stopping new safety rules to protect utility workers from electrocution and coal miners from black lung, as well as rules to limit the power of big banks and corporations. The legislation was approved.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/red-tape-reduction-and-small-business-job-creation-act>

19. Amendment to Extend Middle-Class Tax Cuts

H.Amdt. 1473 to H.R. 8 · August 1, 2012

Position Good for working people

Outcome Failed YEAs 170 NAYs 257

While House Republicans pushed to extend the Bush tax cuts for the nation's wealthiest 2 percent, Democrats offered an amendment that would permanently extend tax cuts on income under \$250,000 for joint filers (\$200,000 for individuals), or about 98 percent of taxpayers and 97 percent of small business owners. The Democratic alternative would save the federal government nearly \$1 trillion over the next 10 years; revenue that could be invested in jobs, infrastructure improvements, education, and protecting programs like Medicare and Medicaid, as well as reducing the deficit. The middle class tax cut was defeated.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/amendment-extend-middle-class-tax-cuts>

20. American Taxpayer Relief Act of 2012

H.R. 8 · August 1, 2012

Position Bad for working people

Outcome Passed YEAs 256 NAYs 171

Not only would the Republican bill extend the Bush tax cuts for the wealthiest 2 percent of taxpayers, H.R. 8 would also raise taxes on approximately 25 million middle and low income households by ending important tax credits for parents raising children and paying for college. Under this plan, the top 2 percent would get an average tax cut of \$150,000 per year. The Republican proposal would eliminate programs for low income families, including the refundable tax credit for college tuition, and both the 2009 expansion of the Child Tax Credit and the Earned Income Tax Credit. The tax cut for the rich passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/american-taxpayer-relief-act-2012>

21. Pathway to Job Creation through a Simpler, Fairer Tax Code Act of 2012

	H.R. 6169 · August 2, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 232 NAYs 189
	This bill would fast track a Republican plan to overhaul the tax code that would cut taxes for the wealthy and corporations, increase tax incentives for corporations that ship U.S. jobs overseas, raise taxes on the middle class, and increase income inequality and the federal deficit. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/house/pathway-job-creation-through-simpler-fairer-tax-code-act-2012

SENATE

1. Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century Act

	S. 1813 · March 14, 2012
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 74 NAYs 22
	The bipartisan Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century Act would create millions of transportation infrastructure jobs, boost the economy and fix the nation's crumbling transportation systems. It authorizes \$109 billion over two years for highway, highway safety and public transit programs. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/moving-ahead-progress-21st-century-act

2. Jumpstart Our Business Startups

	H.R. 3606 · March 22, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 73 NAYs 26
	The "Jumpstart Our Business Startups (JOBS) Act" would reduce critical regulatory protections for investors that are essential to safeguarding the retirement savings of America's workers from fraud and other risks. The so-called "Jobs Act" would create few jobs and would instead inevitably weaken investor confidence in our capital markets by creating new and expanded loopholes in our securities laws. Weakened securities regulations increase the danger of fraud and speculation. The bill passed.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/jumpstart-our-business-startups

3. Paying a Fair Share Act of 2012

	S. 2230 · April 16, 2012
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 51 NAYs 45
	The "Paying a Fair Share Act of 2012", sponsored by Sen. Sheldon Whitehouse (D-R.I.), would implement the so-called "Buffett Rule"—a common sense proposition that the effective federal income tax rate for people who make more than \$1 million should be at least 30 percent. This is an extremely modest first step towards restoring fairness to the tax code. The measure was rejected.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/paying-fair-share-act-2012

4. Repeal of NLRB's Fair Election Rules

	S.J.Res. 36 · April 24, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 45 NAYs 54
	Last year the National Labor Relations Board (NLRB) implemented new democratic union election rules that limited the ability of employers to unfairly delay elections, especially through frivolous and duplicative litigation that previously allowed employers game the system and forced workers to wait months, or even years, before being allowed to vote on joining a union. Sen. Mike Enzi (R-Wyo.) introduced a resolution to prevent the NLRB from implementing the new fair union election rules. The motion was rejected.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/repeal-nlrbs-fair-election-rules

5. Amendment to Limit Union Representation Rights in the Workplace

	S.Amdt. 2046 to S. 1789 · April 25, 2012
Position	Bad for working people
Outcome	Failed YEAs 46 NAYs 53
	Sen. Jim DeMint (R-S.C) offered an amendment to the "21st Century Postal Service Act" that would weaken union representation rights in the workplace. The DeMint amendment would create huge financial burdens on unions by forcing them to spend significant funds on obtaining members signed authorization before participating in worker issue, organizing campaigns and legislative activities at the local, state and national levels. The amendment was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/amendment-limit-union-representation-rights-workplace>

6. Amendment to Circumvent Collective Bargaining Agreements

S.Amdt. 2166 to S. 3240 · June 21, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 45 NAYs 54

Under the guise of "strengthening" workers' collective bargaining rights, Sen. Marco Rubio (R-Fla.) offered an amendment to the Farm Bill that would give employers the right to circumvent provisions on wage increases in collective bargaining agreements, supposedly to allow for merit raises. But under current law, unions and employees can and often do link pay increases and performance as merit-based increases. Nothing in the RAISE Act links pay or benefit improvements to individual achievement or success; rather it eliminates current built-in protections against favoritism, cronyism, and arbitrary action by employers. The amendment was defeated.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/amendment-circumvent-collective-bargaining-agreements>

7. Bring Jobs Home Act

S. 3364 · July 19, 2012
Position Good for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 56 NAYs 42

With American companies shipping more and more jobs overseas, the United States has lost 6 million manufacturing jobs and seen 50,000 manufacturing plants close in the past decade. The Bring Jobs Home Act would cut taxes for U.S. companies that move jobs and business operations back to the United States, and end tax loopholes that reward companies that ship jobs overseas. Senate Republicans mounted a filibuster against the bill, however, and a motion to invoke cloture and break the filibuster did not receive 60 votes and failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/bring-jobs-home-act>

8. Amendment to Extend the Bush Tax Cuts for the Wealthy

S.Amdt. 2573 to S. 3412 · July 25, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 45 NAYs 54

Legislation from Senate Democrats would allow the Bush tax cuts for the wealthy to expire, while preserving breaks for the middle class. Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Ky.) offered an amendment to the bill that not only would extend the Bush tax cuts for the top 2 percent but also would extend estate tax cuts for estates worth more than \$5 million. The McConnell substitute was rejected.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/amendment-extend-bush-tax-cuts-wealthy>

9. Middle Class Tax Cuts Act

S. 3412 · July 25, 2012
Position Good for working people
Outcome Passed YEAs 51 NAYs 48

This Democratic legislation would extend tax cuts on income under \$250,000 for joint filers (\$200,000 for individuals) or about 98% of taxpayers as well as 97% of small business owners. It would end the Bush tax breaks for the richest 2 percent and save the federal government nearly \$1 trillion over the next 10 years; revenue that could be invested in jobs, infrastructure improvements, education, and protecting programs like Medicare and Medicaid, as well as reducing the deficit. The middle class tax cut was passed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/middle-class-tax-cuts-act>

10. Amendment to Repeal Prevailing Wage Laws

S.Amdt. 3376 to H.R. 1 · December 28, 2012
Position Bad for working people
Outcome Failed YEAs 42 NAYs 52

This amendment by Sen. Rand Paul (R-Ky.) to the Disaster Relief Appropriations Act, 2013 (H.R. 1) would have repealed Davis-Bacon coverage for projects funded under this bill. The Davis-Bacon Act requires companies to pay construction workers locally prevailing wages on federally funded projects. The amendment failed.

Source <https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/amendment-repeal-prevailing-wage-laws>

11. Disaster Relief Appropriations Act, 2013

	H.R. 1 · December 28, 2012
Position	Good for working people
Outcome	Passed YEAs 62 NAYs 32
	Passage of the bill that would provide \$60.4 billion in emergency spending for communities hit by Hurricane Sandy. The bill passed on Dec. 28, but House Speaker John Boehner (R-Ohio) delayed final House action on the relief measure which delayed for more than a month most funds for rebuilding the homes and businesses destroyed by the storm, including funding for rebuilding and improving the transportation systems ravaged by Sandy or help for flood control and shore strengthening projects.
Source	https://aflcio.org/scorecard/votes/2012/senate/disaster-relief-appropriations-act-2013